

Insurance, Privacy and Practice Policies

Dental insurance, your personal data, consent, complaints and infection control

Document BSD-POL-02 | Version 1.7 | Effective 1 September 2026

Sample content: Bright Smile Dental is a fictional practice. This document was written for a software demonstration and is not medical advice.

About this document

This document sets out Bright Smile Dental's policies on dental insurance, how patients' personal information is kept and used, consent to treatment, complaints, infection control and patient conduct. Rules for booking, cancelling and paying for appointments are in the separate Appointment, Cancellation and Payment Policy.

Is Bright Smile Dental an NHS practice?

No. Bright Smile Dental is an independent private dental practice and does not provide NHS dental treatment. All treatment at Bright Smile Dental is charged at the practice's private prices, which are shown on the Services page of the website.

Dental insurance: how it works at Bright Smile Dental

Bright Smile Dental welcomes patients who have dental insurance, but the practice does not bill insurance companies directly and is not part of any insurer's network.

If you have dental insurance:

1. You pay for your treatment at Bright Smile Dental on the day, in the usual way.
2. Bright Smile Dental gives you an itemised receipt that lists each treatment.
3. If your insurer has a claim form, bring it to your appointment and the dentist will complete and sign the clinical section.
4. You send the receipt and claim form to your insurer, who pays you back according to your policy.

Dental insurance: checking your cover

Bright Smile Dental cannot check what your insurance policy covers, and cannot guarantee that your insurer will pay for a treatment. Insurance policies often have limits, waiting periods for new policies, and exclusions for cosmetic treatment such as teeth whitening.

For larger treatments such as dental implants or root canal treatment, check with your insurer before treatment starts. Many insurers ask for a treatment estimate in advance, and Bright Smile Dental can provide your written treatment plan for this.

Your personal information

Bright Smile Dental keeps personal information about patients so that it can provide safe dental care. This includes:

- Your name, contact details and date of birth.
- Your medical history, medicines and allergies.
- Your dental records, including notes, X-rays, scans, photographs and treatment plans.
- Your appointment history and payment records.

Your information is used to provide your dental care, contact you about appointments, and meet legal and professional requirements. Bright Smile Dental does not sell patient information and does not use it for advertising.

How your information is kept safe

Patient records at Bright Smile Dental are stored securely and can only be seen by members of the practice team who need them to care for you. Access to clinical records is limited to the clinical team.

Your information is only shared outside the practice when it is needed for your care, for example when you are referred to a specialist or hospital, or when you have asked for it to be shared, such as with your insurer. In rare cases the practice may have to share information when the law requires it.

Dental records are kept for as long as professional and legal guidance requires, and are then securely destroyed.

Seeing your dental records

You have the right to ask for a copy of the personal information Bright Smile Dental holds about you, including your dental records and X-rays. Make the request in writing, by email to hello@brightsmile.example or at reception. Bright Smile Dental will respond within one month and will not normally charge for this.

You also have the right to ask for information that is wrong to be corrected.

Chat assistant and website

Conversations with the chat assistant on the Bright Smile Dental website are stored so that the practice can check the assistant is giving accurate information and improve it. Do not share medical details in the chat that are not needed to book an appointment. The chat assistant does not have access to your dental records.

If you create an account on the website, your account is used only to let you view and manage your own appointments. Passwords are stored in encrypted form and are never visible to the practice team.

Consent to treatment

Bright Smile Dental will not carry out any treatment without your consent. Before treatment, the dentist explains:

- What the treatment involves and why it is recommended.
- The benefits, risks and possible side effects.
- Any reasonable alternatives, including the option of having no treatment.
- The cost, and how many appointments are needed.

You can ask questions at any time and you can change your mind, even after treatment has started. For larger treatments such as implants, you will be asked to sign a consent form and given time to think before treatment begins.

For patients under 16, a parent or guardian gives consent, although young people who fully understand a proposed treatment may be able to consent for themselves.

Making a complaint

If you are unhappy with any part of your care at Bright Smile Dental, please tell the practice. Most concerns can be sorted out quickly by speaking to the dentist or the practice team.

To make a formal complaint, write to the Practice Manager at Bright Smile Dental, 12 High Street, London W1A 1AA, or email hello@brightsmile.example.

The complaints procedure at Bright Smile Dental:

1. Your complaint is acknowledged within three working days.
2. The Practice Manager looks into your complaint and may invite you to a meeting to discuss it.
3. You receive a full written response within ten working days. If more time is needed, you will be told why and kept updated.
4. If you are not satisfied with the response, the practice will tell you which independent body can review your complaint.

Making a complaint will not affect your care at Bright Smile Dental.

Infection control

Bright Smile Dental follows strict infection control procedures to protect patients and staff:

- Reusable instruments are cleaned and sterilised in a dedicated decontamination room after every patient.
- Needles, and many other items such as suction tips, are single-use and are thrown away after each patient.
- Surfaces in the surgery are disinfected between every appointment.
- The clinical team wears fresh gloves and a mask for every patient, and eye protection during treatment.
- Water lines in the dental chairs are disinfected and tested regularly.

Patient conduct

Bright Smile Dental is committed to treating every patient with respect, and asks patients to treat the practice team with respect in return. Abusive, threatening or violent behaviour towards staff or other patients is not tolerated and may lead to a patient being asked to find another dental practice.

Recording at the practice

Patients may not film or record other patients or staff in the practice without permission. Phone calls to the practice are not recorded.